Most Readers Say Flying Cars Are Not Ready to Take Off Yet

From: Live Science Mined: 2026-10-24 5 min read

Are flying cars almost here, or are they still just a dream? Readers of Live Science have strong opinions, and most are not holding their breath.

The debate restarted last week, when Tesla demonstrated a new "flying" edition of its Roadster electric vehicle, called the Rocket Roadster. Some experts remain **skeptical** it is **feasible**, but the demonstration reignited a long-standing argument about flying cars.

In response, Live Science asked readers whether flying cars will be available in the next five years. More than 280 responded. The largest group, 34 percent, chose "No, we need more than five years for flying cars to take off." Next, 23 percent chose "No, flying cars will never happen."

Many comments explained that doubt. One reader, drawing on almost 60 years of driving experience, wrote that most people cannot handle driving in two dimensions, let alone three. The same reader also pointed to hunger, poverty, **inadequate** healthcare, and disregard for the planet, and asked what we are leaving future generations.

Another reader was just as doubtful, arguing a flying car would never become a cheap **alternative** to ordinary vehicles. Gravity rules on this planet, the reader argued, and imagining ordinary people flying above towns, suburbs, cities, and parks raised worries about damage and protests.

Not everyone was so negative. Another commenter praised Tesla's technology, pointing to the Roadster, the Tesla Y, the Cybercab, and Starship as at the **frontier** of science. The same reader argued that Tesla's founder has revolutionized cars and space travel in under 20 years, noting that the first Tesla car was sold in 2008.

The poll does not settle the question. It shows a public that is curious, but mostly cautious. For now, flying cars remain a demonstration and a debate, not something you can buy and fly home.

Word Treasure

skeptical -- Not easily believing that something is true or possible.
feasible -- Possible to do or achieve.
inadequate -- Not good enough, or not enough, for what is needed.
frontier -- The newest or most advanced edge of a subject or activity.
alternative -- Another choice that can be used instead of something else.

Background you need

A flying car is a vehicle meant to travel on roads and also fly through the air.

Flying adds a third direction, up and down, to the usual forward, backward, left, and right of driving.

That raises practical questions about safety, cost, rules for the sky, and what happens above homes and parks.

A demonstration shows an idea in action, but it does not by itself mean the vehicle is ready for everyone to buy and use.

Break it down

LEAD: Live Science readers have strong opinions about flying cars, and most are not holding their breath.

KEY EVENT: Tesla demonstrated a new 'flying' Roadster, the Rocket Roadster, reigniting the debate.

+- WHO: Live Science readers, some experts, and Tesla
+- WHEN: The debate restarted last week; the poll asked about the next five years
+- WHAT: More than 280 readers answered whether flying cars will be available soon

EVIDENCE: The largest group, 34 percent, said more than five years are needed, and 23 percent said flying cars will never happen.

OPEN QUESTION: The poll does not settle whether flying cars will arrive, only that the public is curious but mostly cautious.

Why it matters

How people judge new technology matters beyond cars, because safety, cost, and shared skies affect everyone who lives under them.

Test what you remember

1. What was the largest group in the Live Science poll?

- (A) More than 280 readers in total
- (B) 23 percent who said flying cars will never happen
- (C) Readers with almost 60 years of driving experience
- (D) 34 percent who said more than five years are needed

2. What restarted the debate about flying cars?

- (A) The Live Science poll itself
- (B) Tesla's demonstration of the Rocket Roadster
- (C) The launch of Starship
- (D) The first Tesla car sold in 2008

3. What did the reader with almost 60 years of driving experience argue?

- (A) Flying cars will be cheap for everyone
- (B) Gravity does not apply to flying cars
- (C) Most people cannot handle driving in two dimensions, let alone three
- (D) Tesla's founder changed cars and space travel

4. What worries did another doubtful reader raise about flying over towns and parks?

- (A) Worries about the price of the Tesla Y
- (B) Worries about damage and protests
- (C) Worries about basketball games
- (D) Worries about the first Tesla car

5. What did the more positive commenter praise?

- (A) The idea that flying cars will never happen
- (B) The need for more than five years
- (C) Tesla's technology, including the Roadster, the Tesla Y, the Cybercab, and Starship
- (D) The danger of flying over parks

6. What does the poll show overall?

- (A) That the public is curious, but mostly cautious, and the question is not settled
- (B) That every reader agrees flying cars will arrive soon
- (C) That flying cars are already on sale
- (D) That experts all agree flying cars are feasible

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: C 4: B 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Some experts: Remain skeptical that the Rocket Roadster is feasible.
2. Doubtful readers: Say flying cars need more than five years, or will never happen, and raise worries about driving in three dimensions, cost, damage, and protests.
3. A more positive commenter: Praises Tesla's technology and argues its founder has revolutionized cars and space travel.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):